

Kai Zhang

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WORK EXPERIENCE

NeoCognition Inc. Founding Member of Technical Staff	Palo Alto, CA, USA Sept 2025-Present
Meta SuperIntelligence Labs Research Scientist Intern; Collaborators: Jiacheng Zhu, Shuyan Zhou and Jason Weston	New York, NY, USA May 2025-Aug 2025
Microsoft Research Research Intern; Host: Chenglong Wang and Jianwei Yang	Redmond, WA, USA May 2024-Aug 2024
Google DeepMind Student Researcher; Host: Yi Luan, Hexiang (Frank) Hu, and Ming-Wei Chang	Kirkland, WA, USA Aug 2023-Mar 2024
Microsoft Research Research Intern; Host: Chongyang Tao and Tao Shen	Beijing, China Mar 2022-July 2022

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

(† indicates my mentee. See full list at Google Scholar)

- Agent Learning via Early Experience**
Kai Zhang, Xiangchao Chen, Bo Liu, Tianci Xue, Zeyi Liao, Zhihan Liu, Xiyao Wang, Yuting Ning, Zhaorun Chen, Xiaohan Fu, Jian Xie, Yuxuan Sun, Boyu Gou, Qi Qi, Zihang Meng, Jianwei Yang, Ning Zhang, Xian Li, Ashish Shah, Dat Huynh, Hengduo Li, Zi Yang, Sara Cao, Lawrence Jang, Shuyan Zhou, Jiacheng Zhu, Huan Sun, Jason Weston, Yu Su, and Yifan Wu
In ICML, 2026
- Is Your LLM Secretly a World Model of the Internet? Model-Based Planning for Web Agents**
Yu Gu*, Kai Zhang*, Yuting Ning*, Boyuan Zheng*, Boyu Gou, Tianci Xue, Cheng Chang, Sanjari Srivastava, Yanan Xie, Peng Qi, Huan Sun, and Yu Su
In TMLR, 2025 (*: Equal Contribution)
- MagicLens: Self-Supervised Image Retrieval with Open-Ended Instructions**
Kai Zhang, Yi Luan, Hexiang Hu, Kenton Lee, Siyuan Qiao, Wenhui Chen, Yu Su, and Ming-Wei Chang
In ICML (**Oral**), 2024.
[Data Used in Gemini Embedding v3; Model Used in Snap, Pinterest, and Google](#)
- TravelPlanner: A Benchmark for Real-World Planning with Language Agents**
Jian Xie†*, Kai Zhang*, Jiangjie Chen, Tinghui Zhu, Renze Lou, Yuandong Tian, Yanghua Xiao, and Yu Su
In ICML (**Spotlight**), 2024. (*: Equal Contribution)
- MMMU: A Massive Multi-discipline Multimodal Understanding and Reasoning Benchmark for Expert AGI**
Xiang Yue*, Yuansheng Ni*, Kai Zhang*, Tianyu Zheng*, Ruoqi Liu, Ge Zhang, Samuel Stevens, Dongfu Jiang, Weiming Ren, Yuxuan Sun, Cong Wei, Botao Yu, Ruibin Yuan, Renliang Sun, Ming Yin, Boyuan Zheng, Zhenzhu Yang, Yibo Liu, Wenhao Huang, Huan Sun, Yu Su, and Wenhui Chen
In CVPR (**Oral; Best Paper Finalist**), 2024. (*: Core Contribution)
[Used by Google DeepMind, OpenAI, Anthropic, xAI, NVIDIA, Meta, and Microsoft](#)
- Adaptive Chameleon or Stubborn Sloth: Revealing the Behavior of Large Language Models in Knowledge Conflicts**
Jian Xie†*, Kai Zhang*, Jiangjie Chen, Renze Lou, and Yu Su
In ICLR (**Spotlight**), 2024. (*: Equal Contribution)

7. **MagicBrush: A Manually Annotated Dataset for Instruction-Guided Image Editing**

Kai Zhang*, Lingbo Mo*, Wenhui Chen, Huan Sun, and Yu Su

In NeurIPS Datasets and Benchmarks, 2023. (*: Equal Contribution)

[Data Used in Imagen \(Google\), Emu Edit \(Meta\), and Various Open Models](#)

SELECTED HONORS & AWARDS

Best Paper Award, AI4Research Workshop@AAAI	2025
Best Paper Finalist, ECCV	2024
Best Paper Finalist, CVPR	2024
Valedictorian (Top 1), Zhejiang University City College	2020
National Scholarship (Top 1%), Ministry of Education of China	2019

EDUCATION

The Ohio State University		Columbus, OH, USA
Ph.D. in Computer Science and Engineering	Advisor: Yu Su and Huan Sun	Aug 2022-May 2026
Zhejiang University City College		Zhejiang, China
B.E. in Computer Science and Technology	GPA: 3.99/4.0 Rank: 1/118	Sept 2016-Jun 2020